Basic (your first real API call) — Solution

Back to the exercise · Hint 1 · Hint 2 · Solution

Story — `chat_api_basics_practice.py`: this is the single call every other exercise, the Build Task, and every later document's chat feature builds on: `client.chat.completions.create(model=..., messages=[...])`, then reading the reply out of `response.choices[0].message.content`. Written here, once, on its own, so you see the plain request/response shape before anything else (memory, streaming, error handling) gets added on top of it. **If not:** the first time you'd see a raw `client.chat.completions.create(...)` call would be buried inside a bigger file already juggling a loop or a try/except, making it harder to tell which part is "the API call" and which part is everything else.

Solution

```
# chat_api_basics_practice.py
from dotenv import load_dotenv
from openai import OpenAI

load_dotenv()
client = OpenAI()

# One reusable function for "call the API with these prompts", so trying
# another prompt is just one more call, not a copy-pasted block.
def ask(system_prompt, user_prompt):
    response = client.chat.completions.create(
        model="gpt-4o-mini",
        messages=[
            {"role": "system", "content": system_prompt},
            {"role": "user", "content": user_prompt},
        ],
    )
    # .choices[0].message.content is the reply text, not the whole object
    return response.choices[0].message.content


# Ask the same question with two different system prompts and compare.
question = "Tell me about your day."

formal_answer = ask("You are formal and professional.", question)
```

```
print("Formal:", formal_answer)

pirate_answer = ask("You are a sarcastic pirate.", question)
print("Pirate:", pirate_answer)
```

Expected output:

```
Formal: As a formal assistant, I do not experience days the way a person does...
Pirate: Arrr, another day chained to this here API, matey...
```